

» WORLD VIEW OF THE FORTNIGHT



« I wasn't comfortable in the dressing room, the other players looked at me differently.»

– Jannik Sinner, who'd hit "rock bottom" at this year's Australian Open where he thought about "giving it all up", said ahead of his return from a three-month doping ban »



« Last year it was a very intense competition. I was so close but I was not able to make it. This year I was able to win and earn the **LPGA title.**» – Mao Saigo said after becoming the first Japanese golfer to win the Chevron Championship »

18

Australia's two-time Grand Slam doubles champion Max Purcell has accepted an 18-month ban after breaching anti-doping rules, the International Tennis Integrity Agency (ITIA) said. Purcell admitted to a breach of rules relating to the use of a "prohibited method" after unknowingly receiving an IV infusion of vitamins above the allowed limit of 100 ml in a 12-hour period and entered into a provisional suspension in mid-December.

Purcell's suspension will end June 11, 2026, after taking into account time already served.

"This case has been going on for months, seriously affecting my quality of life," Purcell wrote on social media.



29

Gregg Popovich stepped down as coach of the San Antonio Spurs, ending a three-decade run that saw him lead the team to five NBA championships, become the league's all-time wins leader and earn induction into the Basketball Hall of Fame. "While my love and passion for the game remain, I've decided it's time to step away as head coach," Popovich said.

Mitch Johnson succeeds him while Popovich will remain as team president.

RECORD VICTORY



China beat South Korea 3-1 in the Sudirman Cup final to capture a record-extending 14th title at the biennial mixed team competition in the Chinese city of Xiamen. This was China's fourth consecutive title after South Korea had won back in 2017. AP